

Meeting In D.C., Ends—

Mediation Of Strike Is Failure

WASHINGTON (UPI)—The baseball strike which has marred the opening of the season remained deadlocked today after a two-hour meeting of player and owner representatives with the government's chief labor mediator.

J. Curtis Counts, director of the Federal Mediation and Conciliation Service, said after the session that the talks had been productive in spelling out the issues but no progress had been made toward reaching a settlement on the dispute over pensions.

MARVIN MILLER, executive director of the player's association, and John Gaherin, representing the owners, returned to New York after meeting with Counts. They also reported to their respective sides and possibly will meet again later in the day.

Counts brought both sides together in his Labor Department office after President Nixon expressed hope the 18-day strike could be settled and regular season play begin.

MILLER SAID he was hopeful that the dispute could be ended. But when asked if today's bargaining discussions brought settlement closer, he replied, "I can't say that they did."

Gaherin also said he was "always hopeful" of ending any labor dispute and added: "I think Mr. Counts' involvement has been helpful and I'm glad he is taking an interest in this case."

MILLER EXPRESSED disappointment that the mediation meeting had not "made the kind of substantive agreement that leads to a solution." Gaherin on behalf of the

owners said he thought the dispute would be "soluble with the assistance of Mr. Counts." Counts summarized the situation for newsmen as follows: "As of this moment, there is no agreement. We spent the morning examining the issues involved in the dispute. "The session has been productive in as far as clarifying an understanding of what the problems are. We are recognizing so that both Mr. Miller and Mr. Gaherin can discuss developments with their principals and hopefully come back for further discussions that would lead to a solution."

By JOHN G. GRIFFIN

UPI Sports Writer

AUGUSTA, Ga. (UPI)—Grudgingly—because just thinking about it almost caused him to blow a Masters championship that he had in the bag—Jack Nicklaus conceded today it is now "possible but not very likely" that he can complete the first professional "Grand Slam" in golfing history.

"I'd say the odds have gone down from about 100,000 to 1 to about 1,000 to 1," laughed Nicklaus, shrugging those big shoulders under the green coat that he earned for the fourth time as winner of the Masters. "But it's too soon to really be talking about the chances. If I can win the U.S. Open at

Wins

Nick Of C

El Paso Herald-Post

SPORTS

Edited by Bob Ingram

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Bob Ingram

'As I Was Saying ...'

Triple No-Hitter For 'Hoss'

PAUL (HOSS) LOPEZ had so many near-unbelievable feats in softball pitching that after so long a time they looked almost routine.

But his three no-hit victories in one long night in the state tournament at Odessa in 1968 certainly was a feat out of the ordinary even for Lopez.

The Union Furniture Co. team played in the tournament at Odessa and got into the covers bracket. That meant the team had to win three straight to win the tournament. And Lopez did, beating Lubbock and Odessa teams.

"It was the greatest performance in sports I've ever seen," said Saul Kleinfeld, the Union manager.

"After Lopez had pitched two no-hit games, I asked him if he thought he might be able to pitch the third one. I knew his arm was awfully tired," said Saul.

"He said, 'they've not seen first base yet and they're not going to.'"

Lopez didn't throw the final out until the small hours of the morning.

DeBernardi Honoring Timely

LOPEZ, ALREADY in the El Paso Softball Hall of Fame, will be honored by the El Paso Athletic Hall of Fame tomorrow night at the Sheraton.

Other honorees will be basketball coach C. D. Jarvis of El Paso High School; prep swimmer Jan Welsch of Burges High School; weight man Fred DeBernardi of U.T. El Paso, and Lee Trevino.

And in addition, there'll be a posthumous award for Chuck Hughes which will be accepted by his widow, Sharon. DeBernardi's award will be very timely considering the fact that he won the shot put in the Texas Relays last Saturday.

Trevino has been a fixture in one category or another in the recent El Paso Athletic Hall of Fame awards dinners. After his U.S. Open, British Open and Canadian Open victories last year, Super Mex earned top recognition here once again.

Chuck's Death Was Lesson

I DON'T KNOW whether it'll be pointed out or not in tomorrow night's dinner, but Chuck Hughes death opened the way for better facilities to first heart attack victims on the spot in pro football, and maybe for that matter, in all sports.

Chuck was a heart attack victim in a National Football League game in Detroit last fall. Emergency measures were taken to save his life but they were not enough. Better coronary units will be provided in the future and the lives of some players may be saved as a result.

Andy First One ... Long List

THE ATHLETIC HALL OF FAME affair started in 1955 with Andy Cohen being the first inductee and Margaret Varner Bloss being the second. There has followed a long list of other athletes.

There have been 15 El Paso Athletic Hall of Fame awards dinners. Once a year El Paso takes time out to honor distinguished athletes. The Hall of Fame Committee does an outstanding job and it's a hard one, too. Perhaps some day El Paso will have a room or building or something similar in which photos and mementos of men, women, girls and boys who helped make athletic history here could be placed. In the meantime, it would be nice if you could make your appearance at the Sheraton tomorrow night to help honor a fine group of athletes.

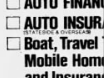
Wales Club Wins

Rugby Tourney

WASHINGTON (UPI)—The Charitable Rugby Club of Cumbria, Wales, defeated the Toronto Irish Canadians 19-4 in the finals of the Cherr Blossom tournament.

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Pro-Am Golf Meet Needs More 'Ams'

Plenty of amateur spots are open for the Ascacate Pro-Am Golf Tournament Wednesday. It kicks off the annual Spring meeting of the New Mexico PGA.

Groups will be allowed to go off as they arrive and play will be one day. Entry fee for the tournament will be \$18.

This tournament gets things going for the big golf weekend here in El Paso.

A second tournament will get underway Thursday at El Paso Country Club.

Miners Lose 2 Close Ones

The U.T. El Paso Miners were unsuccessful in their first Western Athletic Conference encounter of the season, losing three in a row to Arizona last weekend. And they face another WAC power in Arizona State Friday and Saturday at Dudley Field. First, they meet New Mexico State in two games tomorrow at Apoloca Park in Las Cruces.

Mike Beltran, who has an earned run average of 1.60, lost his fourth game of the season for the Miners when the Wildcats beat Andy Cohen's team 3-2 in the first game of Saturday's twill. The Miners lost another tough one in the second game, 9-7. Barry Alburtt and Ely Alvarado did some good hitting for the Miners despite the twin losses.

Roy Campanella Is Satisfactory

VALHALLA, N.Y. (UPI)—Roy Campanella was reported in satisfactory condition for the first time since he was hospitalized here for treatment of a blood clot on the lung.

Although the former Brooklyn Dodger star is still in the intensive care unit of Grasslands Hospital, a hospital spokesman said "he continues to show slow improvement."

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